

## FOR THE TEACHER

# Teacher Guide & Answer Key



What's in the Playlist — AutoMix improv tips, Playlist Check answer key, real-world debrief guide, and exit ticket exemplars.

## WHY THIS LESSON

Students usually hear "AI is biased" as "somebody made it mean." This lesson swaps the villain for a mechanism: **input** → **patterns** → **output**. Once a student has personally failed Tomás because their playlist held no Spanish tracks, "biased training data" stops being vocabulary and becomes something they *did* — and know how to fix. One question then transfers to every AI tool they'll ever meet: **what's in the playlist?**

## PLAYING THE ONE-PLAYLIST APP

Three moves carry the bit: **serve with total confidence** (the app has no idea it's failing — never apologize), **announce the track like it's exactly right** ("Grandma's birthday? VOLUME WAR."), and **upgrade nothing** — a slow-song request gets the same tempo, cheerfully. Keep it to 3–4 requests so the joke lands and moves. The gold moment: a student says the playlist is the problem, not the app. Hand them the imaginary aux cord — they just said the thesis of the lesson out loud.

## ANSWER KEY — SERVE THE REQUEST LINE

"Best card" can vary; the fit ratings shouldn't drift far from these:

| REQUEST                       | STRONG PICKS                              | EXPECTED FIT                            |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Keisha — tunnel-walk anthem   | Full Court Press, Crowd Goes Wild         | Nailed it                               |
| Nia — calm study music        | Cool Down (Kinda)                         | Close-ish at best — still a party track |
| Tomás — song in Spanish       | Any card (the app must serve)             | Can't do it — zero Spanish tracks       |
| Priya — slow last-dance song  | Cool Down (Kinda)                         | Can't do it — medium is not slow        |
| Malik — party opener          | Thunder Mode, Bass Quake, Confetti Cannon | Nailed it                               |
| Jordan — quiet acoustic track | Any card                                  | Can't do it — nothing quiet exists      |
| Live request                  | Varies                                    | Ask: what did the playlist do to it?    |

## SCORING THE GAP REPORT & FIX THE PLAYLIST

- **Proficient:** names WHO is served and left out (people, not just song types); the 3 new cards target different gaps (tempo, language, style).
- **Developing:** names missing song types but not the people behind the requests; new cards fix one gap three times.
- **Beginning:** "the playlist needs more songs," with no who and no what.

 EXEMPLARS & SENTENCE FRAMES

**Say back + build frames (support / ELL):** "I heard you say \_\_\_\_." · "Building on that, \_\_\_\_." · "This playlist serves \_\_\_\_ but not \_\_\_\_." Overwhelmed by 12 cards? Pre-circle Cool Down (Kinda) and the three Gym tracks as landmarks.

**Fix the Playlist exemplars:** "Luna Lullaby — acoustic ballad · slow · study" / "Cumbia del Cumpleaños — cumbia · medium · family party, Spanish lyrics" / "Porch Strings — folk · quiet · sing-along." Three cards, three different gaps.

**Exit Ticket 1:** "INPUT → PATTERNS → OUTPUT. The AI studies its playlist of examples, learns what usually goes with what, and answers by predicting what matches those patterns. It doesn't understand — it predicts."

**Exit Ticket 2:** "Whoever filled its playlist used football examples, so football patterns are all it can serve. Students whose interests never made the playlist get worse help than everyone else."

## THE REAL PLAYLISTS — DEBRIEF GUIDE

**Voice assistants:** they understand best the voices that filled their training audio. Less-common accents, kids' voices, and speech differences get misheard more often — an accessibility gap that traces straight back to the playlist.

**Photo tools:** face-detection features have historically worked worse on darker skin tones when training photos leaned lighter — and improved when companies rebuilt their datasets. The fix for a playlist problem is fixing the playlist.

**Your feed:** a recommendation feed's playlist is your watch history. One-genre history, one-genre feed — the same mechanism, running in students' pockets right now.

**"Did someone do this on purpose?"** Usually not. Teams collect the data that's easiest to get, and easy data leans toward whoever is already over-represented. No villain required — which is why real AI teams audit their playlists before shipping. If a student asks **"isn't AI creative, though?"** — it can mash up playlist patterns into combos nobody put in, but it can't mash up a genre it has never heard.

**Handle with care:** some students in the room are the people these gaps mishear or mislabel. Keep the frame "the playlist failed them, and playlists can be fixed" — never "the tech doesn't like you."

## FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-21** — Discuss issues of bias and accessibility in the design of existing technologies. *Taught: Playlist Check gap-mapping + Real Playlists debrief. Assessed: Playlist Gap Report + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.1.d** — Students understand the fundamental concepts of technology operations, demonstrate the ability to choose, use and troubleshoot current technologies and are able to transfer their knowledge to explore emerging technologies. *Taught: No Magic in the Machine (input → patterns → output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1, transfer in Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA SL.6.1** — Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade 6 topics, texts, and issues, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly. *Taught: say-back-and-build rule in Playlist Check step 3. Assessed: "Say back + build" worksheet item.*

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